Dr. Tesla Picks Tunney on Basis Of Mechanics

Elasticity, Enabling Quickness of Response to Offset the Energy of Mass Impact, Held Vital by Inventor

Both Automata, He Adds

Dempsey Will Rush, but His Eyes Will Be Closed by Opponent, 'Expert' Says

Prizefight "experting" entered a new phase last night when Nikola Tesla, inventor and electrical genius, predicted that Tunney would win to-night in Chicago. Basing his analysis on "the demonstrated principles of mechanics," Dr. Tesla did not hedge or pussyfoot, but declared that Tunney was "at least a ten to one favorite."

In December, 1914, Dr. Tesla made an analysis of the World War, employing his methods of mechanics. His widely published prediction that the war would last five years was laughed at by most military critics.

"This fight seems a silly and ephemeral thing," Dr. Tesla said, "but whatever interests such vast numbers of people must have some underlying significance. My interest in boxing dates from my friendship with John L. Sullivan. He was a great, baby-minded fellow, very likable, and I made something of a study of his fight with Corbett. I have thought a good deal about this Dempsey-Tunney affair, and I am convinced that mechanical principles give a clear indication of what the results will be."

Inventor Discusses Fight

Sitting in his suite at the Hotel Pennsylvania, the seventy-one-year-old inventor, whose discoveries have revolutionized the transmission of electrical current, discussed the battle of Chicago with the manner of a professor demonstrating a tricky experiment in physics.

"To understand the principles involved," he said, "we must first dismiss the illusory idea that the results observable in a fight of this character spring from a free will. Such a motive does not exist, for the men are merely automata, wholly controlled by external influences."

Dr. Tesla hastened to explain that he did not mean to imply that the fight was fixed or "in the bag." The men will fight as automata, he said, but as automata thoroughly bent on battering each other to the canvas. The gamblers will revolve in their own orbits, he indicated, colliding with and influencing each other, but having no gravitational influence on the fighting automata.

Says Quickness Counts

"What counts in a contest of this kind," Dr Tesla continued, "is quickness of response. The more skillful man who can back while at the same time defending himself can reduce greatly the intensity of his antagonist's blows while keeping his own effective. To illustrate: If a fighter attacked back with half the speed of the assailant's blow, the force of the impact will be reduced to one-half, while the energy of the impact will be reduced to one-quarter.

"Tunney is far superior in quickness of response. His perceptions will enable him to avoid the full force of Dempsey's blows and, like Corbett at New Orleans, to defeat a stronger opponent having greater mass. Moreover, we have had an experimental test. The two fighting machines have already collided. True, it is said that one of the machines was then defective and has since been repaired, but meanwhile the other machine has improved, especially in quickness of response."

Dempsey can overcome Tunney's superiority in this respect, Dr. Tesla believes, only by rushing in and trading body blows at close quarters. "The slugging machine must chase the boxing machine and drive in bruising blows at any cost," he said. "That is Dempsey's natural method. He abandoned it for a while but the Sharkey fight showed he is getting back to it. On the other hand the powerful popular concentration on foul blows caused by that fight will hurt Dempsey's automatic slugging powers.

"Tunney will hit Dempsey continuously and at will. He will probably fail to knock him out. But at the end Dempsey's face will be badly pulped and both his eyes will be nearly closed."

Dr. Tesla went on to discuss elasticity and inelasticity of tissue, the importance of mass and the significance of the angle of impact. At the end of the interview, however, he commented briefly on a more human factor. "Forgetting mechanics for a moment," he said, "there is a potent human reason why Tunney will win. He is single, and other things being equal, the single man can always excel the married man."

Dr. Tesla smiled significantly. He is a lifelong bachelor.